

HUNING CASTLE NEIGHBORHOOD ASSOCIATION

HCNA Neighborhood Newsletter, Spring 2026

President's Message: Brenda Marks, HCNA Neighborhood Association Board President

I want to begin by thanking every one of you who has served as a board member during my Presidential tenure, or attended an event, or helped us organize an event, or has written a letter to our City Council fighting for our neighborhood. This year has been special. Our board members, Rudy Garcia, Anna Lamberson, Erika Harding, Lara Bryson, Mark and Joanne Pinkalla, Robert Rodriguez, Fred Rivera, Lynn Hightower, Jon Patterson and Kendall Corley have been extraordinarily talented and effective. It has been my pleasure to serve all of you, and I know whoever is elected to serve as our next President will have your strong support as well.

This has been my final year to serve as President. Three years is enough and change at the top is good for an organization. In a neighborhood organization like ours, it ensures we include new residents to the neighborhood and, most importantly, it provides new perspectives, ideas and opinions.

The bios of all the candidates for the Board are printed in this newsletter. I hope you will review them and be prepared to cast your votes at the annual meeting on May 13. Three seats are for three-year terms and the fourth for one year (the completion of Anna Lamberson's term who is leaving a year early). We hope and encourage the candidate who is elected to complete Anna's term will commit to continuing for a full term in 2027, as well. We will also be confirming Joanne Pinkalla's board membership, since she was appointed by the board last year.

We're finally joining the 21st Century by creating a website to use to instantly notify all residents of



problems, issues, concerns, and happenings. Beginning with the new board year, we will be up and running and this newsletter may fall by the wayside. Our new website can instantly notify anyone of anything, and we are going to make sure it functions that way. The HCNA Alert system will still function, just a bit differently.

If any of you have materials that the neighborhood needs to see or be notified about, those can also be posted on the website. We will also have a neighborhood calendar on which events of interest and important dates can be noted.

We still have a need to maintain the ability to raise funds to cover our costs and website expenses without dues paying members, so we plan to include a donation button using Square Space, Stripe, PayPal or another payment service. We are researching them now. HCNA has always been blessed with generous members who donate funds to help us do lots of things. We also have yearly expenses related to National Night Out in August and Harvest Fest in October. So, you can be certain that your funds will be used for activities that we all can enjoy.

Again, my sincere thanks for your support over the past three years. I love this neighborhood, and I know it will continue to thrive.

Brenda Marks

Albuquerque's New Bike Law, Or

"Welcome to The Idaho Stop"

Several months ago, one of our neighbors asked the Board to report on recent amendments to Albuquerque's City Ordinances which pertain to bicyclists. As I have been a regular bike commuter for the past decade or so, a Boardmember asked me to research the issue and submit a report. Sorry for the delay, but better late than never.

In November 2025, Mayor Keller signed Council Bill O-25-98, which amended the City's traffic code "to improve protections for bicyclists, pedestrians, and other vulnerable users." The Ordinance purports to incorporate "best practices" that have evolved significantly since the adoption of the City's Traffic Code (in 1994, I believe...). One of those best practices that has been adopted by numerous other cities has become known as the Idaho Stop.

An Idaho Stop may seem counter-intuitive, as it permits bicyclists to treat stop signs as yield signs (i.e. bikes can coast through intersections without stopping) and red lights as stop signs (i.e. bikes need to stop, but can then proceed through the red light). By allowing cyclists some measure of latitude with respect to the laws applicable to automobiles, studies have shown that the Idaho Stop enhances safety and efficiency by allowing cyclists to maintain their momentum, reduce unnecessary stops,

and avoid lingering in intersections. Indeed, it has been proven that the policy reduces bicycle-related injuries and has been adopted by over a dozen states, starting with Idaho in 1982, with no evidence of increased accidents.

Albuquerque's version of the Idaho Stop can be found in § 8-3-3-5, "Obedience to Traffic Control Devices". § 8-3-3-5(A)(1) states that, at a red light, cyclists still need to come to a stop, but can then go through the intersection if there is no approaching traffic.

§ 8-3-3-5(A)(2) states that, at a red light, a cyclist "may proceed through the intersection without stopping" if there are no other vehicles approaching or in the right of way. The new Ordinance makes other changes to the traffic code governing bicycles; if you use an electric bike or other mobility device (e.g. skateboards, scooters, wheelchairs), or generally ride bikes in and around our City, I encourage you to give it a closer read. For this bike commuter, though, it appears that the new ordinance is unfortunately not widely known, as I recently learned when a driver yelled at me that I "broke the law" when I rolled through the stop sign at 7 th and Central. After I explained the Idaho Stop to him, he thanked me and sped off. Progress, I guess. Hopefully, when you see this maneuver executed in the future, you'll applaud the cyclist's good riding (and savvy knowledge of the traffic laws)! As a bike commuter, I am grateful to our City Council and our Mayor for adopting current best practices and trying to promote bike use and bike safety in our City. Keep riding!

John Robbenhaar, HCNA Neighbor

5 STEPS TO SAFER CYCLING

Bike during the day in low-traffic areas.

Does the Tour of Utah motivate you to dust off your bicycle? **Michael Henrie, D.O.**, a sports medicine physician at University of Utah Health, offers these tips to stay safe while cycling:

- Ditch the headphones.** "Listening to music while biking can impair your ability to hear pedestrians and traffic," Henrie says.
- Wearing a helmet** reduces risk for head injury by up to 85%. Make sure yours fits properly. It should sit level and snug on your head, two finger widths above your eyes.
- Wear bright colors, and use reflective gear** so that others can see you.
- Using a flashing LED headlight and tail light** to increase your visibility.

KNOW THE RULES OF THE ROAD Obey traffic rules. Bike on the right side of the road, use hand signals and ride defensively.

- LEFT TURN**
- RIGHT TURN**
- STOP**
- RIGHT TURN (ALTERNATIVE)**

healthcare.utah.edu/orthopaedics/programs/cyclists-clinic.php

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2026 HUNING CASTLE NEIGHBORHOOD ANNUAL MEETING: AGENDA

Wednesday, May 13, 2026

Albuquerque Country Club Banquet Room, 6 pm

All residents of the Huning Castle neighborhood are cordially invited and encouraged to attend.

All residents of Huning Castle are automatically enrolled as members of the Association. Dues are not required, but suggested contributions of \$25 (for individual residents) and \$40 (for business members) are welcome and encouraged. Check or cash payment ONLY at meeting. Payment may also be made via Zelle through your bank account.

- 1) Registration begins at 6 pm. The meeting will commence promptly at 6:30 pm.
- 2) Call to order & opening remarks, Brenda Marks
- 3) Adoption of minutes from April 8, 2026 regular board meeting.
- 4) Special Guest and presenter Carl Christensen of the Bernalillo County Water Authority to provide information about resources, rebates and programs available to save you money on your water bill.
- 5) Ten minutes allotted for persons who may want to speak before the meeting.
- 6) ADP Crime/Safety Report, Brittany Martinez, Crime Prevention Specialist
- 7) HCN Safety Patrol Report, Rudy Garcia
- 8) Committee reports:
 - a) Quorum announcement (membership present)
 - b) Treasury: Kendall Corley
 - c) HCALERT, Lara Bryson
 - d) Communications subcommittee working on new website and new methods of communication
- 9) Recognize departing board members Erika Harding, Anna Lamberson, and Lynn Hightower. Rudy Garcia and Brenda Marks have kindly agreed to serve another term.
- 10) Announcement of new board members to serve 2026 - 2029.
- 11) Adjournment

Emergency Action Plan

Rudy Garcia

Summer is rapidly upon us and with it will come the potential for fire danger in the bosque. As residents of HCNA, we enjoy the beauty of the bosque, but we also must recognize the risk it can present should a wildfire occur, especially during extremely dry, windy, and hot weather.

Each household should have an emergency action plan should we have to prepare for an emergency. Residents in HCNA should establish a personal and/or family disaster plan. This plan should include the following six steps:

1. Decide where your family will regroup and how your family will make contact after a disaster. (Assume cell phones will not work.)
2. Make sure you know how to turn off the water and other utilities at your home and at work.
3. For each person in your home, stock up on at least three gallons of water, at least a three-day supply of non-perishable food, and a manual (non-electric) can opener.
4. Also have on hand: (1) a flashlight; (2) a portable radio; (3) extra batteries; and (4) a first aid kit.
5. Keep your gas tank as full as possible.
6. Read and take action on Federal Emergency Management Agency's (FEMA) online publication Make a Plan.

If we plan well now, we will be ready should an emergency require us to evacuate our homes and move to safer locations. Let's be prepared so that we can ensure safety during an emergency. The following FEMA website is good for building a disaster Supply Kit: https://www.fema.gov/pdf/areyouready/appendix_b.pdf

What You Should Do in an Emergency

1. Act on your personal and family disaster plan.
2. Listen for and act on all instructions from your elected City officials and other local authorities.
3. Access information via all functioning media, including radio and TV station news and the City website (www.cabq.gov).
4. Call 311 if you have questions.
5. If so instructed, go to the shelter nearest to you.
6. If so instructed, evacuate.
7. If you are instructed to evacuate and do not have transportation, call 311.

Being prepared when an emergency occurs is essential to keeping ourselves and our families safe. If you would like additional information on building a plan or an "emergency to go bag" please feel free to email me (Rudy Garcia) at rmgconsults@msn.com.

Let's all be safe and prepared.

The Groove

ARTSPACE

FIND YOUR CREATIVE GROOVE

Fab art classes for ALL ages right in the neighborhood!

GET IN THE GROOVE

The Groove Artspace is a welcoming downtown art space offering classes for all skill levels, interests, and paces.

Whether you're trying something new or getting back into the flow—there's a place for you here.

EXPLORE OUR CLASSES

- GLASS FUSING, CASTING & ENAMELING
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309 GOLD AVE SW, ABQ 🌸 WWW.THEGROOVEARTSPACE.COM

VOLUNTEER OPPORTUNITY: HELP TURN FOOD WASTE INTO COMPOST

We'd like to let your readers know about a volunteer opportunity for neighbors who want to help reduce the 112,000 tons of food waste that end up in Albuquerque's landfill each year — and turn some of those scraps into clean, nutrient-rich compost that restores soil, supports earthworms, and nourishes gardens and trees.

Just south of the Downtown Neighborhoods, on 7th St., the Barelás Senior Center runs a small community garden. Inside the garden is a composting site operated by volunteers and overseen by the City of Albuquerque Sustainability Program.

Though modest in size, the Community Composting Coop plays an important role in the City's efforts to cut food waste and reduce methane and CO₂ emissions from landfills. We are now recruiting new volunteers to help keep this effort thriving.

Here's how it works: The City provides wooden bins and tools. Volunteer composters, after taking the free class and hands-on workshop, bring their own — and sometimes their neighbors' — food scraps and garden waste. Gardeners contribute green waste from their plots, and the Barelás Senior Center adds food scraps from its meal program. Volunteers weigh and add materials, keep the compost moist, monitor for non-biodegradable items, and maintain the site. A few times a year, members gather for larger tasks such as sifting finished compost.

Along with the satisfaction of shrinking your carbon footprint and spending time with like-minded neighbors, volunteers receive the very tangible reward of high-quality, beautifully finished compost.

If this sounds appealing, visit the City's website to learn more (www.cabq.gov/compost) or contact the City's Sustainable Waste Specialist, Sandra West at swest@cabq.gov. **No prior experience is needed. Volunteers attend a training on Southwest composting practices and an orientation to the site. Spring classes are in early May, so now is the perfect time to join.**



Caption: Community Compost Volunteers caring for the compost pile.

HCNA Board Candidate Bios – For your Consideration

Hello Neighbors,

My name is Clara Hardgrave, and I am interested in representing you on the HCNA board. Before moving to our neighborhood, we lived in Reynolds and dreamed of living here, with its walkable streets, beautiful parks, and family-friendly atmosphere. Twenty years ago, our dream became reality when we moved into our pink 3-bedroom house. We have since remodeled the house and added Abel (my brother), my healthy 90-year-old mother, Jessie, our 11-year-old son Lucas, and our 9-year-old daughter, Francesca. You may have seen Abel cruising up Park in his wheelchair to get to his favorite coffee shops, my daughter with a friend selling lemonade, or my son shooting baskets in front of our house. Or perhaps you have seen us walking our dog throughout the neighborhood, as we frequently pass by our lot on Escalante. Two years ago, we hoped to build our dream home to meet our family's needs, but we put it on hold. We have considered moving, but our neighborhood is a priceless gem that is impossible to duplicate elsewhere in the city. So we are waiting for construction costs, inflation, and other economic factors to decrease so we can build our second dream home in our neighborhood. As you can tell, I am invested in our neighborhood and feel that my interests and knowledge, representing a variety of abilities and ages, add another asset to a well-rounded board. I hope you will consider me for the board.

David Kleinfeld has lived and worked in downtown Albuquerque for many years. As a resident of the Huning Castle Neighborhood Association (HCNA), he values the neighborhood's unique character, history, and location and welcomes the opportunity to become more involved in the association and neighborhood governance.

David brings extensive volunteer and board experience. Over the past 30 years, he has served on boards including the City of Albuquerque Open Space Advisory Board, Opera Southwest, the Uptown Association and the Albuquerque Museum Foundation. He also has practical experience in property management and HOA operations, including service on an Architectural Control Committee.

Tony Gradillas who is running for a board seat was unable to send his bio, but asked if we could list his name. His family moved into the neighborhood about 2 years ago. He and his wife have two small boys. He loves the neighborhood and enjoys outdoor sports especially mountain biking. He and his wife love interacting with the other families in HCNA and the kindness of the neighborhood.

Please join us to meet all board candidates and your neighbors – the HCNA Annual Meeting will be held Wednesday May 13, 2026, 6-pm at the Albuquerque Country club Banquet Room.